

Mary noticed him checking her out. It had been a long time since a man had looked at her in that way, other than her husband of course, and Mary couldn't help but feel flattered. She pretended not to notice him. He was barely twenty, if that, and had the sleek physique of a young man involved in contact sports. He reminded her of the blond guy on the *Dukes of Hazzard* show her oldest son used to watch.

By the time she'd gotten to Aisle 2, she realized she'd forgotten the cans of chunk chicken that were on sale and she had a coupon for, so she headed back to the previous aisle and ended up only inches away from the blonde Adonis who was chucking several cans of beef ravioli into his cart. Mary felt his eyes on her as she pulled three coupons from her coupon box and put the matching three cans of chicken in her cart. She realized that she also had several coupons in the box good on ravioli. Her children hated canned pasta, so with her heart beating wildly, she offered the man her four coupons to apply towards his purchase. He accepted them with a smile that could advertise any of the tooth-whitening toothpaste.

Mary headed for Aisle 3, noticing that the young man followed quickly behind her. Determined to show him that she was way more than just a pretty face, she carefully compared coupons to sale prices, dropping six boxes of the rice dishes she had coupons for into her cart. They would cost her just a few cents each. Mary's coupon fever rose as she briskly went from aisle to aisle, matching coupons to sale prices. By the time she reached the baby food aisle she'd almost forgotten the young man who was watching her.

"Well, there goes my cover," she thought as she put twelve jars of baby food (free with coupon) into her cart. "Now he knows I have a baby," her thoughts continued. "But surely he would never guess I have five older children."